

# 7-Day Foundational Wellness Protocol

*Your Personal Guide to Building Lasting Health Habits*

This protocol is designed for individuals beginning their wellness journey. Over seven days you will establish foundational habits across four pillars: Sleep, Hydration & Nutrition, Movement, and Mental Wellness. Each day builds on the last, creating a compounding effect that sets the stage for long-term health transformation.

Important: This protocol is educational and supportive in nature. Always consult a qualified healthcare provider before making significant changes to your diet, exercise, or health routine.

## General Rules

- Track every habit daily using your wellness journal or the app check-in feature.
- Drink at least 2.5 litres of water per day, starting with a glass upon waking.
- Aim for 7-9 hours of sleep each night; consistency of sleep schedule matters more than total hours.
- Avoid screens for at least 30 minutes before bed to protect sleep quality.
- Eat at least 5 portions of vegetables and fruit daily.
- Limit added sugar to fewer than 25 g per day.
- Do not skip meals; eat within 1 hour of waking to stabilise blood sugar.
- Take 10 deep diaphragmatic breaths every morning before leaving bed.
- Journal for at least 5 minutes each evening -- note one win and one challenge.
- Weigh yourself at most once per week, same time, same conditions.

## Dos & Don'ts

### Do

- [+] DO start each day with a glass of water before coffee or tea.
- [+] DO prioritise protein at every meal (eggs, legumes, meat, dairy, tofu).
- [+] DO go outside for at least 15 minutes of natural light each morning.
- [+] DO celebrate small wins -- habit streaks build momentum.
- [+] DO communicate any concerns or questions during your daily check-in.
- [+] DO adapt movement intensity to how you feel -- rest is productive too.
- [+] DO use a consistent bedtime routine: dim lights, no screens, calm activity.

### Don't

- [-] DON'T weigh yourself more than once per week -- daily fluctuations are misleading.
- [-] DON'T skip the evening journal -- reflection drives behaviour change.
- [-] DON'T attempt extreme caloric restriction during this protocol.
- [-] DON'T use this protocol as a substitute for medical advice.
- [-] DON'T compare your progress to others -- this protocol is personalised for you.
- [-] DON'T drink alcohol during the 7-day programme; it disrupts sleep architecture.
- [-] DON'T exercise intensely if you slept fewer than 5 hours -- opt for a gentle walk.

## Tracking Rules

- Log sleep duration and quality (1-5 scale) each morning.
- Log water intake in 250 ml increments throughout the day.
- Log meals with a brief description -- no calorie counting required.
- Log movement type and duration after each session.
- Log mood (1-10 scale) at noon and at bedtime.

---

#### 7-Day Foundational Wellness Protocol

- Log your one win and one challenge in the evening journal.
- Share a brief check-in summary with your coach every day via the agent.
- If you miss a tracking entry, do not skip the next -- just continue.

## Day 1: Baseline & Orientation -- Theme: Awareness

### Today's Objectives

- Complete your wellness profile with the coach.
- Establish baseline measurements: resting heart rate, sleep quality, energy (1-10).
- Drink 2.5 L of water today -- set hourly reminders if helpful.
- Go for a 20-minute gentle walk, any time of day.
- Journal: Write 3 things you want to feel like at the end of this week.

### Sleep Guidance

Tonight, set a consistent bedtime. Aim for 7.5-8 hours. Put your phone in another room or use night mode 30 minutes before bed.

### Nutrition Guidance

No specific meal plan today. Simply observe your current eating patterns without judgment. Note what you eat and when in your journal.

### Movement Guidance

20-minute gentle walk. No intensity target today -- just move.

### Coach's Note

Day 1 is about awareness, not perfection. Notice your habits without changing them drastically. Curiosity is your best tool today.

## Day 2: Sleep Optimisation -- Theme: Rest & Recovery

### Today's Objectives

- Implement a 30-minute wind-down routine tonight.
- Avoid caffeine after 2 pm.
- Complete your morning gratitude breathing (10 deep breaths).
- Hydrate: 2.5 L water minimum.
- Add one serving of leafy greens to a meal today.

### Sleep Guidance

Wind-down routine: dim lights at 9 pm, avoid screens, try reading or stretching. Keep the bedroom cool (16-19 degC is optimal for sleep). Avoid large meals within 2 hours of bedtime.

### Nutrition Guidance

Prioritise protein at breakfast (20-30 g). This stabilises blood sugar and reduces cravings throughout the day. Examples: eggs, Greek yoghurt, protein smoothie.

### Movement Guidance

25-minute walk or gentle yoga. Keep it easy today.

### Coach's Note

Sleep is the foundation of every other health metric. One good night's sleep improves mood, focus, metabolism, and willpower.

## Day 3: Hydration & Nutrition Focus -- Theme: Fuelling Well

### Today's Objectives

- Drink a large glass of water immediately upon waking.
- Eat at least 5 servings of vegetables and fruit.
- Limit added sugar to under 25 g today.
- Eat within 1 hour of waking.
- Identify one processed food to reduce or eliminate.

### Sleep Guidance

Maintain yesterday's wind-down routine. Consistency over 3 nights begins to shift your circadian rhythm positively.

### Nutrition Guidance

Build a balanced plate: 50% vegetables, 25% protein, 25% complex carbohydrates. Choose whole grains over refined (brown rice, oats, quinoa). Avoid liquid calories -- juice, soda, and energy drinks spike insulin sharply.

### Movement Guidance

30-minute walk. Try adding 5 minutes of body-weight strength work: 10 squats, 10 push-ups (modified is fine), 20-second plank.

### Coach's Note

Hydration affects energy, mood, and cognition more than most people realise. If you feel a 3 pm slump, drink water before reaching for caffeine.

## Day 4: Movement & Strength -- Theme: Building Physical Capacity

### Today's Objectives

- Complete a 30-40 minute movement session of your choice.
- Achieve 7,000+ steps today.
- Stretch for 10 minutes after movement.
- Continue all hydration and sleep habits.
- Journal: How has your energy changed since Day 1?

### Sleep Guidance

Exercise improves sleep quality but should be completed at least 3 hours before bedtime to avoid elevated cortisol disrupting sleep onset.

### Nutrition Guidance

On higher-movement days, add a complex carbohydrate source at the meal before your session (oats, sweet potato, banana). Post-session, consume protein within 45 minutes.

### Movement Guidance

Choose an activity you enjoy: brisk walk, cycling, swimming, strength training, dance class. Duration matters more than intensity at this stage. Target: moderate effort where you can hold a conversation.

### Coach's Note

Regular movement is the closest thing to a 'wonder drug' in health research -- it improves sleep, mood, insulin sensitivity, cognitive function, and longevity.

## Day 5: Mental Wellness & Stress Management -- Theme: Mind & Emotions

### Today's Objectives

- Complete a 10-minute guided meditation or mindfulness practice.
- Identify your top stressor this week and write one small action to address it.
- Spend 20 minutes on an activity purely for enjoyment (no productivity).
- Practice 4-7-8 breathing before bed: inhale 4s, hold 7s, exhale 8s.
- Continue all prior habits.

### Sleep Guidance

Stress is the number-one disruptor of sleep quality. The 4-7-8 breathing technique activates the parasympathetic nervous system and significantly reduces time to sleep onset.

### Nutrition Guidance

Foods that support mental wellness: oily fish (omega-3), dark leafy greens (magnesium), fermented foods (gut-brain axis), dark chocolate (70%+, 1-2 squares). Avoid ultra-processed foods and alcohol, which worsen anxiety and mood stability.

### Movement Guidance

Today, a 20-minute walk in nature counts as both movement AND mental wellness. Research shows green-space exposure reduces cortisol.

### Coach's Note

Mental health is physical health. Chronic stress raises cortisol, disrupts sleep, increases appetite for high-calorie foods, and impairs immune function. Managing stress is non-negotiable in a wellness protocol.



## Day 6: Habit Stack & Integration -- Theme: Compounding Your Habits

### Today's Objectives

- Review all five previous days -- which habit felt most natural?
- Design your personal 'morning habit stack' (3-5 habits chained together).
- Complete all daily habits without reminders if possible.
- Share your habit stack with your coach during check-in.
- Plan your meals for the next day in advance.

### Sleep Guidance

A consistent sleep and wake time -- even on weekends -- is the single most powerful sleep intervention. Aim to be within 30 minutes of the same schedule 7 days a week.

### Nutrition Guidance

Meal planning reduces decision fatigue and prevents impulsive food choices. Prepare at least one component in advance: pre-washed vegetables, cooked grains, or portioned snacks.

### Movement Guidance

35-minute session of your preferred activity from Day 4.

### Coach's Note

A 'habit stack' links a new habit to an existing one using the formula: 'After I [existing habit], I will [new habit].' Example: 'After I pour my morning coffee, I will drink a full glass of water first.'

## Day 7: Reflection & Forward Planning -- Theme: Review & Renewal

### Today's Objectives

- Complete a full written review: energy, sleep, mood, movement, nutrition.
- Identify your 3 biggest wins from this week.
- Identify 2 habits you want to strengthen in Week 2.
- Set one health goal for the next 30 days.
- Celebrate -- you completed the 7-Day Protocol!

### Sleep Guidance

Compare tonight's sleep to Day 1. Most participants report meaningfully improved sleep quality by Day 7 -- even modest habit changes accumulate. Commit to maintaining your sleep schedule in Week 2.

### Nutrition Guidance

Notice if your relationship with food has shifted -- many participants report reduced cravings, steadier energy, and improved appetite regulation. These are signs your metabolism is beginning to recalibrate.

### Movement Guidance

Active recovery day: a relaxed 25-minute walk or gentle stretch session. You have built a movement habit this week -- honour it.

### Coach's Note

Seven days doesn't transform your body, but it does transform your awareness. You now have data about your own patterns, and that knowledge is powerful. The real work -- and the real rewards -- begin in Week 2 and beyond.